Additives

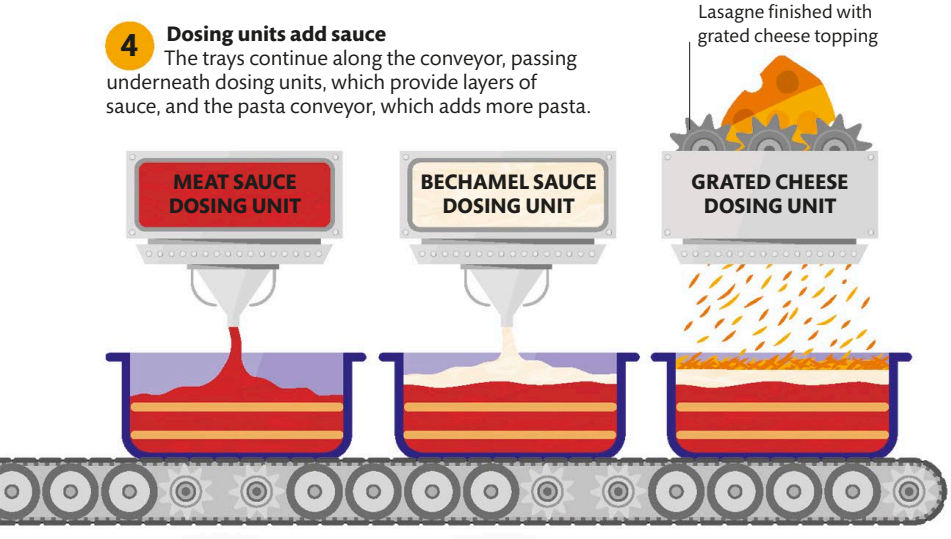
Food additives are often viewed as a bad thing, but many are necessary to preserve the appearance, taste, and shelf life of processed foods. Processing can also destroy nutrients and natural colors and flavors, so these have to be added back in. Common additives include bulking agents, preservatives, thickeners, acidulants (which increase acidity), sweeteners, and colorants. Many additives are natural products, and all additives have to meet regulatory standards.

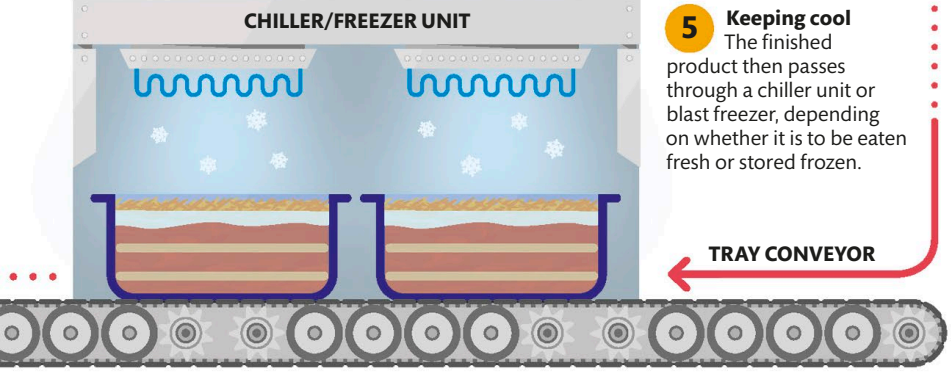
Emulsifiers
These are used to thicken sauces and prevent unmixable components, such as oil and water, from separating out. They are found in ice cream, mayonnaise, and dressings.

Flavorings
Flavor enhancers, such as salt and monosodium glutamate (MSG), are additives used to improve the natural flavor of the food, which is often lost when food is processed.

Nutrients
Processing can remove nutrients and vitamins that then have to be added later. Breakfast cereals, for example, commonly have added B vitamins and folic acid.

4 Dosing units add sauce
The trays continue along the conveyor, passing underneath dosing units, which provide layers of sauce, and the pasta conveyor, which adds more pasta.





5 Keeping cool
The finished product then passes through a chiller unit or blast freezer, depending on whether it is to be eaten fresh or stored frozen.

THE FIRST READY MEAL WAS CREATED IN 1953 TO USE UP LEFTOVER THANKSGIVING TURKEY

AIRPLANE FOOD

Extra additives have to be added to in-flight ready meals, since our ability to smell and taste food at high altitude diminishes. Salt and sugar become particularly difficult to taste in the low pressure and humidity of aircraft cabins. Spices are often added to increase flavor.



AIRPLANE READY MEAL